

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

must do so before you lose the lead. That means you must establish the ♣ suit **NOW**.

Win the ♦ A, play ♣ A and ruff the ♣ 2 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ 10 and ruff the ♣ 4 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ J and ruff the ♣ 8 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ A and discard a loser on the good ♣ 9.

It took a 4-3 ♣ split to make this contract.

Fortunately that occurs a high percentage of the time. In any case, there was no other hope.

Responding to preempts is easy. You don't count points, you just count tricks. Assume partner for 6 tricks and add yours to see how high to go (or not go).

Here, with three Aces and a possible ♠ ruff you raise to game.

South would play 4♥.

Click

North plays 4♥. West leads the ♦ K.

Things look grim. The defense has exposed your ♦ losers already and those two ♠ losers seem pretty obvious also. If you are to make this contract you

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6
 ♥ A 8 4
 ♦ A Q 8
 ♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5
 ♥ K Q 6
 ♦ K J 10 3
 ♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

You have 16 points - a pretty solid 16 in fact. Partner has 15, 16 or 17, so together you have 31, 32 or 33. You want to invite partner to bid 6NT if he has 17, but to decline if he has 15. The correct bid for this invitation is 4NT. It is called a "quantitative" 4NT since it is just an invitational raise. It is **NOT** Blackwood - if you wanted to ask for Aces you would use Gerber.

Partner bids the slam.

West would play 6NT.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
4NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by East			

Click

East plays 6NT. South leads the ♠ 3.

East plays 6NT. South leads the ♠ 3.

Winner count: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's pretty clear which suit you have to worry about! Your goal is simple, you must win one ♠ trick before you lose two. So the crux of your problem is: Who holds the ♠ A and ♠ Q?

If South has both of them you are guaranteed to win the first trick no matter what you play.

If North has both of them you are going to lose the first two tricks no matter what you play.

The problem is to decide what to do if they are split. The answer relies on psychology, not on probability. South has made an attacking lead. But if you were South would you start out leading a low ♠ from a suit like ♠ A 9 7 3? That would be incredibly foolhardy, you would probably lead a different suit and save your ♠ A for catching something high from declarer. On the other hand you would be quite likely to lead a small card from ♠ Q 9 7 3.

Your PLAN should be to play low in dummy and win your ♠ 10 if North withholds the ♠ A.

If you think South has ♠ A 9 7 3 then you should play the ♠ K from dummy. But if you think South has ♠ Q 9 7 3 you should play low from dummy.

Since South is unlikely to underlead an Ace against 6NT you play North for the ♠ A.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

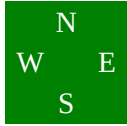
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5
♥ K Q 6
♦ K J 10 3
♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

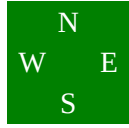
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 11

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 15

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

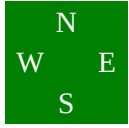
Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2
♥ 10 9 5 3
♦ 7 4 2
♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5
♥ K Q 6
♦ K J 10 3
♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 6 5
♣ 8 6 2

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 27

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 33

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

Board 35

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4
♥ 4 3
♦ 10 7 4
♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7
♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 6



♠ K 9 5 2
♥ 9
♦ K Q J 9
♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10
♦ A 6 3
♣ A 9 8 4 2

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

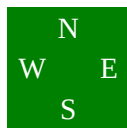
♠ K 8 6
♥ A 8 4
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2